serviceDiscovery MQTT/TLS/JSON

Interface Design Description

Service ID: *"serviceDiscovery"*

Abstract
This document describes the MQTT protocol with TLS payload security and JSON payload encoding variant of the `serviceDiscovery` service of the ServiceRegistry system.

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1 Overview

This document describes the `serviceDiscovery` service interface of the ServiceRegistry system over MQTT, which provides registration and lookup of service instances: which provider offers which service definition, in which version, through which interfaces and with which security policy.

It's implemented using protocol, encoding as stated in below table:

Profile type	Type	Version
Transfer protocol	MQTT	3.1.1 [1]
Data encryption	TLS	1.3 [2], 1.2 [3]
Encoding	JSON	RFC 8259 [4]
Compression	N/A	-
Semantics	N/A	-
Ontology	N/A	-

Table 1: Communication and semantics details used for the `serviceDiscovery` service interface

This document provides the Interface Design Description IDD to the *serviceDiscovery – Service Description* document [5]. The operations, their semantics and the data models are the same as in the HTTP/TLS/JSON IDD [6]; this document specifies the MQTT binding.

The MQTT interface is offered only when the system runs with `mqtt.api.enabled=true`; it is then registered with the interface template `generic_mqtts` (`generic_mqtt` without TLS), the broker address and port (`mqtt.broker.address`, `mqtt.broker.port`) and the base topic `arrowhead/serviceregistry/service-discovery/`. In the Arrowhead-test-cloud-java deployment the MQTT interfaces of the core systems are disabled.

2 Service Operations

The provider subscribes to one topic per operation, the base topic followed by the operation name:

Operation	Request topic
`register`	`arrowhead/serviceregistry/service-discovery/register`
`lookup`	`arrowhead/serviceregistry/service-discovery/lookup`
`revoke`	`arrowhead/serviceregistry/service-discovery/revoke`

A consumer publishes a request envelope (MqttRequestTemplate) to the topic and receives the answer (MqttResponseTemplate) on its own `responseTopic`. The `authentication` field carries the requester's identity according to the provider's authentication policy: `IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>` (outsourced or internal policy), `SYSTEM//<name>` (declared policy) or the requester's X.509 certificate (certificate policy). The `status` of the response uses the HTTP status code numbers (200, 201, 204, 400, 401, 403, 404, 408, 423, 500, 503); on error the payload is an ErrorMessage.

```
{
  "traceId": "a1b2c3",
  "authentication": "IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>",
  "responseTopic": "arrowhead/response/TemperatureDisplay/a1b2c3",
  "qosRequirement": 1,
  "params": {},
  "payload": {}
}
```

Listing 1: Request envelope.

```
{
  "status": 200,
  "traceId": "a1b2c3",
  "receiver": "TemperatureDisplay",
  "payload": {}
}
```

Listing 2: Response envelope.

2.1 PUBLISH `arrowhead/serviceregistry/service-discovery/register`

Operation: register
Input: ServiceInstanceCreateRequest
Output: ServiceInstanceResponse

Registers a service instance of the requesting system. An existing instance with the same identifier is replaced. Unknown service definitions are created; interfaces are validated against their templates.

```
{
  "serviceDefinitionName": "temperatureReading",
  "version": "1.0.0",
  "expiresAt": "2026-10-22T12:00:00Z",
  "metadata": {
    "unit": "celsius"
  },
  "interfaces": [
    {
      "templateName": "generic_https",
      "protocol": "https",
      "policy": "CERT_AUTH",
      "properties": {
```

```
        "accessAddresses": [
          "192.168.0.10"
        ],
        "accessPort": 8080,
        "basePath": "/temperature",
        "operations": {
          "read": {
            "method": "GET",
            "path": "/read"
          }
        }
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

Listing 3: Payload of an register request.

2.2 PUBLISH `arrowhead/serviceregistry/service-discovery/lookup`

Operation: lookup
Input: ServiceInstanceLookupRequest
Output: ServiceInstanceListResponse

Returns the service instances matching all given filters. Under the restricted discovery policy, a requester without direct access only receives instances whose service has the `unrestrictedDiscovery` metadata (the core services). With `verbose=true` the provider and device details are included.

Optional entries of `params`: `verbose`.

```
{
  "instanceIds": [
    "TemperatureSensor|temperatureReading|1.0.0"
  ],
  "providerNames": [
    "TemperatureSensor"
  ],
  "serviceDefinitionNames": [
    "temperatureReading"
  ],
  "versions": [
    "1.0.0"
  ],
  "alivesAt": "2026-10-22T12:00:00Z",
  "metadataRequirementsList": [
    {
      "unit": "celsius"
    }
  ],
  "addressTypes": [
    "IPV4"
  ],
  "interfaceTemplateNames": [
    "string"
  ],
  "interfacePropertyRequirementsList": [
    {
      "unit": "celsius"
    }
  ],
  "policies": [
    "string"
  ]
}
```

Listing 4: Payload of an lookup request.

2.3 PUBLISH `arrowhead/serviceregistry/service-discovery/revoke`

Operation: revoke
Input: String

Removes a service instance of the requesting system. Returns 200 if removed, 204 if it did not exist.

```
1 "TemperatureSensor|temperatureReading|1.0.0"
```

Listing 5: Payload of an revoke request.

3 Data Models

Here, all data objects that can be part of the service calls associated with this service are listed in alphabetic order. Each *struct* denotes a JSON Object with the named fields; fields that are not needed may be omitted.

3.1 struct MqttRequestTemplate

The request envelope.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"traceId"	String	Identifier chosen by the requester, returned in the response.
"authentication"	String	Identity of the requester (see Section 2).
"responseTopic"	String	Topic on which the response is published.
"qosRequirement"	Number	MQTT QoS of the response (0, 1 or 2).
"params"	Object<String>	Optional parameters (the query parameters of the HTTP binding).
"payload"	Object	The operation input.

3.2 struct MqttResponseTemplate

The response envelope.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"status"	Number	Status code.
"traceId"	String	The trace identifier of the request.
"receiver"	String	Name of the requester.
"payload"	Object	The operation output, or an ErrorMessage.

3.3 struct ErrorMessage

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"errorMessage"	String	
"errorCode"	Number	
"exceptionType"	ExceptionType	
"origin"	String	

3.4 struct Address

A network address with its type.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"type"	String	Address type: `HOSTNAME`, `IPV4`, `IPV6` or `MAC`.
"address"	String	One network address (host name, IPv4, IPv6 or MAC address).

3.5 struct DeviceResponse

A registered device.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"name"	String	Device name.
"metadata"	Object	Free-form metadata (JSON object).
"addresses"	Array<Address>	Network addresses with their types.
"createdAt"	DateTime	UTC time of creation.
"updatedAt"	DateTime	UTC time of the last change.

3.6 struct MetadataRequirement

A JSON object of metadata requirements: each key is a metadata path (dot notation), each value the required value or an operator object such as `{"op": "LESS_THAN", "value": 10}`.

3.7 struct ServiceDefinitionResponse

A service definition.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"name"	String	Service definition name.
"createdAt"	DateTime	UTC time of creation.
"updatedAt"	DateTime	UTC time of the last change.

3.8 struct ServiceInstanceCreateRequest

Registers a service instance of the requesting system.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"serviceDefinitionName"	String	Service definition name, camelCase (e.g. `temperatureReading`).
"version"	Version	Version of the service instance (default `1.0.0`).
"expiresAt"	DateTime	UTC expiry time; no value means no expiry.
"metadata"	Object	Free-form metadata (JSON object).
"interfaces"	Array<ServiceInstanceInterface Request>	Service interfaces offered by the instance.

3.9 struct ServiceInstanceInterfaceRequest

One interface of a service instance.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"templateName"	String	Name of the interface template, snake_case (e.g. `generic_https`).
"protocol"	String	Protocol of the interface, e.g. `http`, `https`, `mqtt`, `mqtts`.
"policy"	String	Security policy of the interface (`NONE`, `CERT_AUTH`, token policies).
"properties"	Object	Interface properties defined by the template, e.g. `accessAddresses`, `accessPort`, `basePath`, `operations`.

3.10 struct ServiceInstanceInterfaceResponse

One interface of a service instance.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"templateName"	String	Name of the interface template, snake_case (e.g. `generic_https`).
"protocol"	String	Protocol of the interface, e.g. `http`, `https`, `mqtt`, `mqtts`.
"policy"	String	Security policy of the interface: `NONE`, `CERT_AUTH` or one of the token policies.
"properties"	Object	Interface properties defined by the template, e.g. `accessAddresses`, `accessPort`, `basePath`, `operations`.

3.11 struct ServiceInstanceListResponse

List of service instances.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"entries"	Array<ServiceInstanceResponse>	Matching records of the current page.
"count"	Number	Total number of matching records (all pages).

3.12 struct ServiceInstanceLookupRequest

Filter for service instances; all fields optional, combined with AND.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"instanceIds"	Array<String>	Instance identifiers to match.
"providerNames"	Array<String>	Provider system names to match.
"serviceDefinition Names"	Array<String>	Service definition names.
"versions"	Array<Version>	Service versions to match.
"alivesAt"	DateTime	Only instances that are still registered (not expired) at this UTC time are matched.
"metadataRequirements List"	Array<MetadataRequirement>	Requirements on the service instance metadata; each map is one alternative.
"addressTypes"	Array<String>	Address types the interfaces must offer (`HOSTNAME`, `IPV4`, `IPV6`, `MAC`).
"interfaceTemplate Names"	Array<String>	Accepted interface templates, e.g. `generic_https`.
"interfaceProperty RequirementsList"	Array<MetadataRequirement>	Requirements on the interface properties; each map is one alternative.
"policies"	Array<String>	Interface security policies to match, e.g. `CERT_AUTH`.

3.13 struct ServiceInstanceResponse

A registered service instance.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"instanceId"	String	Service instance identifier `<System>|<serviceDefinition>|<version>`, or policy instance identifier.
"provider"	SystemResponse	The provider system.
"serviceDefinition"	ServiceDefinitionResponse	The service definition.
"version"	Version	Version of the service instance.
"expiresAt"	DateTime	UTC expiry time; no value means no expiry.
"metadata"	Object	Free-form metadata (JSON object).
"interfaces"	Array<ServiceInstanceInterface Response>	Service interfaces offered by the instance.
"createdAt"	DateTime	UTC time of creation.
"updatedAt"	DateTime	UTC time of the last change.

3.14 struct SystemResponse

A registered system.

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"name"	String	System name.
"metadata"	Object	Free-form metadata (JSON object).
"version"	Version	Version of the system.
"addresses"	Array<Address>	Network addresses with their types.
"device"	DeviceResponse	The device hosting the system, if registered.
"createdAt"	DateTime	UTC time of creation.
"updatedAt"	DateTime	UTC time of the last change.

3.15 Primitives

As all messages are encoded using the JSON format [4], the following primitive constructs, part of that standard, become available.

Type	Description
Array	A JSON Array [4]; Array<A> has elements of type A.
DateTime	JSON String with an ISO 8601 UTC timestamp, e.g. `2026-10-22T12:00:00Z`.
ExceptionType	One of `ARROWHEAD`, `INVALID_PARAMETER`, `AUTH`, `FORBIDDEN`, `DATA_NOT_FOUND`, `TIMEOUT`, `LOCKED`, `INTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR`, `EXTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR` (JSON String).
Number	JSON Number, an integer.
Object	JSON Object; Object<A> has string keys and values of type A.
String	JSON String.
Version	JSON String, semantic version `major.minor.patch`.

4 References

[1] A. Banks and R. Gupta, “Mqtt version 3.1.1,” OASIS, Standard, 2014.

[2] E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.3,” IETF, RFC 8446, 2018.

[3] T. Dierks and E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.2,” IETF, RFC 5246, 2008.

[4] T. Bray, “The javascript object notation (json) data interchange format,” IETF, RFC 8259, 2017.

[5] J. Delsing, “serviceDiscovery – Service Description (ServiceRegistry),” Eclipse Arrowhead, SD 5.2.2, 2026, serviceRegistry-v5.2.2-serviceDiscovery-SD.pdf.

[6] ——, “serviceDiscovery HTTP/TLS/JSON – Interface Design Description (ServiceRegistry),” Eclipse Arrowhead, IDD 5.2.2, 2026, serviceRegistry-v5.2.2-serviceDiscovery-HTTP-IDD.pdf.

5 Revision History

5.1 Amendments

No.	Date	Version	Subject of Amendments	Author
1	2026-10-22	5.2.2	Document created from the Arrowhead LaTeX templates for the 5.2.2 Java Spring implementation, including the local extensions of this workspace.	Jerker Delsing

5.2 Quality Assurance

No.	Date	Version	Approved by
1		5.2.2	